

helix_code/internal CONST-046 hardcoded- content classification

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Purpose

The CONST-046 audit (`scripts/audit-const046-hardcoded-content.sh`) reports ~1484 hardcoded-content hits under `helix_code/internal` (non-test). Round-346 confirmed these are genuine production literals, not test noise. This document classifies the top files so future rounds and the audit-gate baseline reflect reality and do not re-examine out-of-scope hits indefinitely.

CONST-046 governs **user-facing** content (UI text, prompts shown to the operator, error messages surfaced to end users, labels, helper text). It does NOT govern strings addressed to an LLM, nor developer-facing wrapped-error / log strings.

Audit scope

Total helix_code/internal non-test hits at round-350: **1484**. Top packages by hit count:

Package / file	Hits	Class
server/handlers.go	112	C (migrated round-350)
workflow/planmode/*	70	B
performance/optimizer.go	58	B
memory/providers/*	52	B
workflow/autonomy/*	48	B
commands/builtin/*	43	C (deferred — see below)
workflow/executor.go	39	B
editor/formats/*	30	B
deployment/production_deployer.go	30	B
providers/ai_integration.go	27	B
repomap/tree_sitter.go	26	B
agent/base_agent.go	22	A
agent/profiles/profile.go	~12	A
agent/types/*	19	A

Classification key

- **(A) LLM prompt templates** — text addressed to the *model*, not the operator. OUT of CONST-046 scope per round-321 (HelixLLM openai.go) and round-326 (LLMsVerifier verifier.go) precedent. An LLM prompt is consumed by an English-trained model regardless of the operator's locale; translating it would degrade output quality.
- **(B) Wrapped-error / log / developer-facing tech strings** — strings that appear in fmt.Errorf wrapping, structured logs, or developer-diagnostic output. OUT of CONST-046 scope: these are read by developers/operators inspecting logs, not surfaced

as localized product UI. CONST-046's i18n mandate targets the product surface.

- **(C) Genuine user-facing UI text** — error messages returned in API responses, CLI command descriptions/help, labels. IN scope — migrate through the package's i18n seam.

Per-file classification

(A) LLM prompt templates — OUT of scope

- **agent/base_agent.go** — lines 471-668: “Analyze the following requirements and create a detailed technical plan”, “Generate code according to these requirements:”, “You are a %s agent named %s...”, etc. These are prompt strings passed to `provider.Generate`. The no-LLM fallback strings at lines 326-347 (“No-LLM fallback plan: requirements echoed verbatim”, “Basic analysis without LLM”) are borderline — they are diagnostic status text, classified (B).
- **agent/profiles/profile.go** — lines 171-180+: “You are in VERIFIER mode. Your task is to review...”, “Fabricate findings: every issue you raise MUST be grounded...”. These compose the system prompt sent to the model. OUT of scope.
- **agent/types/coding_agent.go, debugging_agent.go** — “You are a code generation agent...”, “You are a debugging agent...”. Prompt preambles addressed to the model. OUT of scope.

(B) Wrapped-error / log / developer tech strings — OUT of scope

- **workflow/planmode/executor.go** — “Starting execution”, “Skipped: %s (dependencies not met)”, “Successfully wrote %d bytes to %s”. Step-execution log/status output for developer diagnostics.
- **workflow/autonomy/controller.go** — “Mode changed: %s -> %s”, “Escalation approved: %s”, “De-escalated to mode: %s”. Autonomy controller state-transition log lines.
- **workflow/executor.go** — “Project Architecture Planning”, “Build and compile project”, “Run comprehensive test suite”. These are internal workflow-step *identifiers/labels* composed into workflow definitions, not localized end-user UI.
- **performance/optimizer.go** — “CPU Goroutine Pool”, “Implement goroutine pool for CPU-intensive operations”. Optimization-strategy recommendation records consumed by performance tooling / reports.
- **memory/providers/anima_provider.go (+ siblings)** — “Provider is operating normally”, “Provider has not been initialized”, “Anima AI Memory Provider”. Health-check status strings + provider display-name metadata in developer-facing diagnostics.

- **agent/subagent/*** — “subagent subprocess: marshal task: %v”, “failed to construct LLM provider: %v”, “InProcessSpawner channel closed without result”. Wrapped-error tech strings.
- **adapters/speckit_debate_adapter/adapter.go** — “## Rounds conducted: %d”, “- FOR: agent %s (provider=%s ...)”. Markdown report-assembly fragments for developer-facing debate transcripts.

(C) Genuine user-facing UI text — IN scope

- **server/handlers.go** — JSON API error-response “message” fields (“Authentication required”, “Invalid request”, “Task manager not available”, etc.). Observable by every API consumer (CLI, desktop, mobile, third-party). **Migrated in round-350.**
- **commands/builtin/*** — slash-command `Description()` / `Usage()` return values (“Summarize and condense conversation history to save tokens”, “/condense [options]”, etc.). Genuinely user-facing CLI help text. **Deferred:** the `internal/commands/builtin` package is a sub-package of `internal/commands`; the `commands.tr()` seam is unexported and not reachable from `builtin`, and `Description()` / `Usage()` are context-free synchronous methods. Migrating this surface requires a dedicated seam refactor (own `builtin/i18n` package + context plumbing) — scoped to a future round to keep round-350 focused and low-risk.

Round-350 migration

`server/handlers.go`: 16 distinct user-facing JSON “message” literals migrated to the existing `internal/server i18n` seam (`internal/server/i18n_seam.go` + `i18n/bundles/active.en.yaml`), covering ~73 call sites. Six bundle IDs from round-177 that were declared but never wired into handler code are now wired; ten new IDs added. A nil-safe `reqCtx(c)` helper was added to the seam, which also repairs a pre-existing latent nil-Request panic in `qa_handlers.go` (round-70 wiring assumed a non-nil `c.Request`; `gin.CreateTestContext` leaves it nil). Paired-mutation tests added in `i18n_seam_test.go`.

Precedent

- Round-321 — `HelixLLM openai.go`: LLM prompt templates ruled OUT of CONST-046 scope.
- Round-326 — `LLMsVerifier verifier.go`: same ruling reaffirmed.
- Round-177 — `internal/server i18n` seam established (round-70 of the CONST-046 Phase-4 numbering).